

Q+A

An Appetite for Acting

It's a chef, it's an actor, it's... **Ranveer Brar**

Q. You will be opening a restaurant in Dubai soon. How long has this plan been cooking?

Nine months. I had been saying no to many restaurant projects because I wanted to spend more time with family. But Dubai is a booming market, and Indian food has reached a space where people appreciate where we come from... It just felt right.

Q. What can one expect?

My food philosophy has changed. Right now, it is simpler; it's not trying to make a statement but keeping it easygoing and honest. I want to create a place that is not overtly imposing and to serve food that stays with you. There are no fires or liquid nitrogen here. It's Indian food that you connect with.

Q. After *Modern Love*, you are working with Hansal Mehta again. Did *MasterChef India* empower you to face the camera?

My travel shows have helped. When you're travelling and interacting, you're free to react and it makes you oblivious to the camera. Initially, I was scared of acting and felt characters would stay and I wouldn't be able to go back to being myself. But I realised they leave something that makes you better. I love acting now as it lets me explore grey characters. Hansal Sir has given me that with *The Buckingham Murders*.

Q. Running restaurants and a popular YouTube channel, judging a TV show, acting...one senses you have your fingers in too many things. How do you manage it all?

Having a short-term memory helps. Fifty per cent of it is being in the moment and delivering what you are faced with. Surrounding yourself with people who understand you and let you be and know when to intervene also helps.

Q. What does freedom mean to you?

Freedom to me means expressing myself while allowing others to express themselves.

with Suhani Singh

MANDAR DEODHAR